

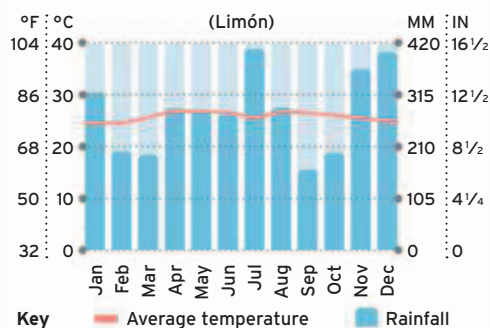
LOCATION

Costa Rica is located on the Central American isthmus between North and South America.



CLIMATE

Costa Rica has a dry, tropical climate. The Caribbean has a more even spread of rain than the Pacific side.



Honduran white bat

Ectophylla alba

This tiny white bat lives in rainforests where large-leafed heliconia plants are plentiful. Feeding on fruit at night, they roost during the day in tents that they construct by nibbling either side of a leaf's midrib so that the sides collapse, forming an inverted V that protects them from rain and sun. Their snow-white fur is tinted green as sunlight filters through the bright green leaves, thus camouflaging them from potential predators.



- ↔ 2 in (5 cm)
- ⚖ ¼ oz (7.5 g)
- ⊗ Near threatened
- 🍌 Fruit pulp, fig seeds
- 🏠 🌿



◁ LEAF TENT

Honduran white bats roost in groups of 4-10, usually a single male and his harem of females, underneath a leaf 6 ft (2 m) off the ground.

Hoffmann's two-toed sloth

Choloepus hoffmanni

Sloths live in slow motion to conserve energy. Their metabolism is about 50 percent slower than that of other similarly sized mammals. Their intestine is shorter than a carnivore's—a trait usually associated with a fast-acting digestion—yet the plant-based diet takes 6-21 days to be digested. This, however, allows sloths to extract the maximum nutrition from low-energy food and may also help neutralize toxins. Awkward and vulnerable on the ground, where the sloth descends once a week to defecate, the algae in its fur conceals it in the trees from predators such as harpy eagles and jaguars.

▷ HANGING AROUND

Sloths spend most of their lives in trees, where they eat, sleep, mate, and give birth—all while dangling upside down from their huge, hooked claws.

- ↔ 22-30 in (56-76 cm)
- ⚖ 9-19 lb (4-8.6 kg)
- ⊗ Common
- 🍌 Leaves, buds, fruit, sap
- 🏠 🌿 🌿 🌿



750,000 species of insect

UMBRELLA SPECIES

The black-headed bushmaster viper preys on small mammals, such as spiny rats and marsupials, and lays its eggs in burrows made by other animals. Conservation of this species would benefit many others.

BUSHMASTER VIPER

